Pronouns & clear sentences

QUICK REFERENCE | Suggested grades 1-4 | English

A pronoun can take the place of a noun. Make it clear who or what it means.

Choose a pronoun

Subject: does the action	Object: receives the action
I, you, he, she, it, we, they	me, you, him, her, it, us, them

Subject or object?

Maya and I read. I is part of the subject.

The teacher helped Maya and me. Me is part of the object.

Check by removing the other name: I read. The teacher helped me.

Possessive words show belonging

My/your/his/her/its/our/their come before nouns: our books.

Mine/yours/his/hers/ours/theirs can stand alone: The books are ours.

Its or it's?

Its shows belonging: The bird spread its wings.

It's means it is or it has: It's raining.

Make the meaning clear

Unclear: Sam told Lee that he won. Which person won?

Clear: Sam told Lee, "You won." Or: Sam told Lee, "I won."

OPP